

Knitting vs Crochet

How to tell the difference and avoid upsetting the fiber artist in your life

Class Handout - Instructor: Amy O'Connell

Fiber art refers to fine art whose material consists of natural or synthetic fibers, such as cotton, linen, wool, silk, and acrylic [1].

Fiber arts can be roughly categorized into **felt work** and **string work** [2].

Felt work: matting, condensing, and pressing fibers together to form textiles and other forms



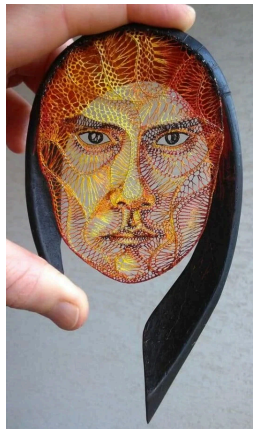
Original felted wool painting by Sarazen AnYin

String work: spinning loose fiber into yarn or string and manipulate string to form textiles

- Includes handspinning, knot work, lace work, and weaving practices (see examples below)



"Mizuhiki plant" by Clément Bucco-Lechat - Mizuhiki traditional Japanese art form



Needle lace portrait by Agnes Herczeg



"Nalbinding sock" by AnnaKika - Nålbinding historical discipline

Knitting and Crochet: Similar, but **not the same**

Knitting and **crochet** are two of the most accessible and widespread fiber arts.

Both knitting and crochet involve

- Using yarn form textiles
- Small handheld tools
- Creating objects and garments that are soft, warm, and aesthetically pleasing

Although the process and finished objects can look similar, **knitting and crochet are not the same**, and it is important to be able to tell the difference between them!

Goal: This handout will act as a simple and straightforward guide to understanding the difference between knitting and crochet.

Part 1: Tools

The easiest way to determine if a person is knitting or crocheting is to look at the tools they are using.

Knitting uses **two or more needles**, like this:



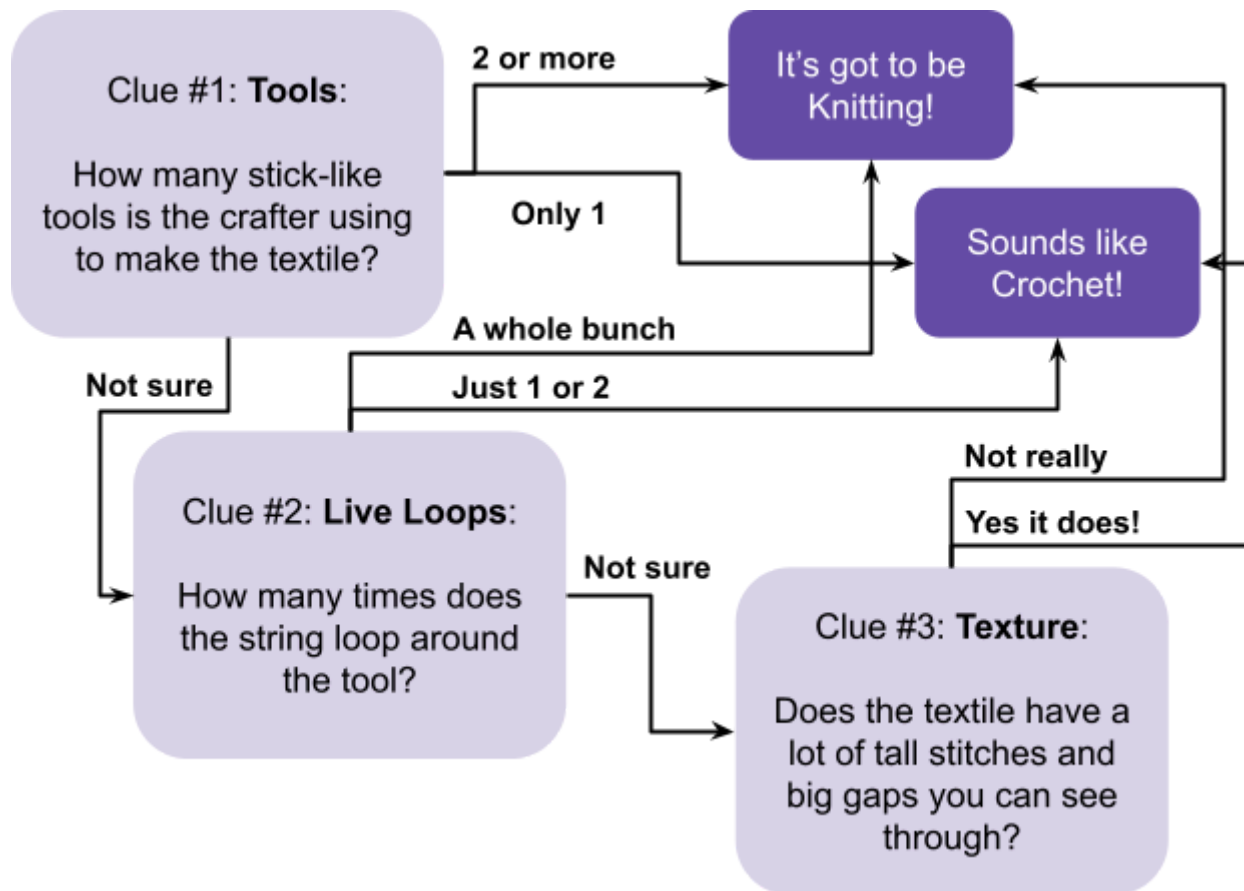
[3]

While **crochet** **always** uses **one hook**, like this:



[4]

Is it **knitting or crochet**? An infographic decision guide:



Resources for further reading:

[1] *Fiber art* - https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Fiber_art

[2] Sarazen An Yin's *Complete Guide To (57) Almost All Types Of Fiber Arts With Photos* - <https://sarazenanyin.com/types-of-fiber-arts/>

[3] *Knitting* - <https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Knitting>

[4] *Crochet* - <https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Crochet>